

September/October Newsletter 2025

(12 pages if possible)

Are you ready?

Andrea Charlton - Guide, Grab and Go Bags, SHASA presentations to community groups

Peace of mind comes with being prepared for anything you can reasonably expect to happen over an Australian Summer. The Eurobodalla - like other parts of Coastal Australia - has experienced major bushfires, floods, and storms. Rising temperatures mean that these events are likely to be more frequent, and more intense, in the future. So, what can you do about it? You can make a plan, by yourself, with your household, or in your neighbourhood or community.

People who experienced those emergencies last time tell us that having a plan in place meant they were able to respond faster, were less likely to experience loss that can't be repaired, and report better mental health one to five years later.

Do you have a plan for your household?

If you had to leave your home, where would you head for? What would you take with you? How about pets? Does anyone need regular medications? Special equipment?

At what point would you decide to leave?

The Australian Red Cross has a kit to help households to make a plan - SHASA has booked a workshop for 22 October to help SHASA members to fill their plans out in company, with the help of local emergency responders who have experience. Check out their resources at

<https://www.redcross.org.au/prepare/>

Take one step at a time



Get in the know

[Learn more >](#)



Get connected

[Learn more >](#)



Get organised

[Learn more >](#)



Get packing

[Learn more >](#)

In an emergency, you often don't have time to think, let alone pack. By packing a survival kit in advance, you can save yourself a lot of time and stress. There are lots of suggestions on line if you search for Bug Out Bags or Grab and Go bags. Everyone's bag will be different, but the process of

packing yours will help you to make sure that the things you really need will be to hand and ready when you need to leave. Think about your essential documents, irreplaceable sentimental objects, pets and their supplies, children and their needs. If you plan to see out the emergency in your home, your bag might be a box of non-perishable food and plenty of drinking water in your pantry or garage.

The Tec Exec is looking for suitable Grab and Go bags for our location and our members. Watch this space for more details.

There are also several apps for your smartphone that will help you to keep in touch with what's going on - during emergencies, ABC Radio South East is our official emergency broadcaster so you need to be able to tune in. A battery radio is extremely helpful, with back up batteries stored outside of the appliance. You can also get radio on your phone with the ABC Listen app.

Would you like to find out more? There are many opportunities to learn about preparing your home and household. The Rural Fire Service has a Get Ready Weekend on 21-22 September - check what's on at your local RFS Shed.

Your local NSW SES Batemans Bay Unit will be attending several Playdates with Emergency Services starting in mid October. The volunteers would love to chat to you about your local flood, storms and tsunami risks and what you can do to prepare, respond and recover. This is a free family event - please drop by and say Hi - there's one near you.

Date

13 October 2025, 5:30 pm – 7 pm

Where

Corrigans Beach Reserve, Beach Road, Batehaven

Date

16 October 2025, 5:30 pm – 7 pm

Where

Quota Park, Riverside Drive Narooma

Date

20 October 2025, 5:30 pm – 7 pm

Where

Mogo Sports Oval, Park Street, Mogo

Date

23 October 2025, 5:30 pm – 7 pm

Where

Riverside Park, Ford Street Moruya

September's green light for free green-waste drop-off

From Monday 15 to Sunday 28 September the tips will accept your green waste for free.

It's the perfect start to your fire-season preparations and the timing sits nicely with the NSW RFS Get Ready Weekend on 21-22 September. Use the time to think about all the material on your property - old furniture, packing cases, cardboard, paper, poorly maintained decking, this is a good time to pass those on also.

There's a 2 cubic metre limit for [Moruya](#)'s waste transfer station. Bigger loads - 2 cubic metres or more - should go to the [Brou](#) or [Surf Beach](#) facilities please.

Southern Life Church - The Eurobodalla's largest Bushfire and Heatwave Haven

Thanks to a grant of \$168,668 (GST inclusive) from Club Grants 3 (Infrastructural Grants) NSW Government, SHASA has been upgrading the Southern Life Church Food Hall and Church Hall to operate as a Haven during extreme weather events for clients of The Pantry, Church members and their families. Works included:

- 29.92kW solar PV system and 20kWh battery on the Church Building
- 26.4kW solar PV system and 40kWh battery on the Food Hall
- Starlink satellite and training
- 4 internal air filters
- 2 fire pumps, 4 fire hoses and fittings
- Back up generator for the Food Hall

SHASA would like to thank our trusted local businesses including:

- Micro Energy Systems
- Camerons Hardware Moruya
- Betta Batemans Bay
- Blue n Grey Water and Septic Solutions

This is the 8th operational Bushfire and Heatwave Haven in the Eurobodalla. It will be officially opened by Dr Michael Holland, MP for Bega, 1pm on 13 October. For more details on havens go to www.shasa.com.au

Long Term partnership drives community success

The team from Micro Energy Systems has again demonstrated their commitment to sustainable community development through recent successful installations in the Eurobodalla region. Their long term partnership with SHASA continues to deliver more projects supporting local organisations to reduce their environmental footprint.

While SHASA assists these organisations with funding solutions to implement solar and storage projects, collaboration with Micro Energy Systems extends far beyond installation day. The team from Micro Energy Systems commits to supporting these organisations as long-term customers, with ongoing service over the next 10-15 years. This enduring partnership allows SHASA to confidently continue providing innovative, sustainable solutions that empower our community.

Southern Life Church: A Solar and Storage Milestone

Recently, Micro Energy Systems completed a significant upgrade at Southern Life Church, installing photovoltaic (PV) solar and battery storage systems. Despite being on separate buildings, these systems are connected behind the same meter and have been cleverly configured to operate seamlessly via monitoring programming, maximizing energy efficiency and cost savings.

Further enhancements are underway, with scheduled upgrades to the electrical infrastructure aimed at improving resilience and enabling emergency power supply for essential circuits across both buildings. In a generous gesture, Micro Energy Systems has donated \$5,000 to SHASA's public fund to support these critical upgrades, reinforcing their commitment to long-term community sustainability.

Expanding Solar Footprint at Narooma Men's Shed

Micro Energy Systems has recently installed an additional 14.96kW PV solar system at the Narooma Men's Shed, utilizing micro-inverters for optimal performance. This new system builds upon the shed's existing solar and storage infrastructure, helping to offset the increasing energy loads being seen at the Shed and reducing operational costs.

For more updates on community projects stay tuned to SHASA's newsletter or contact Micro Energy Systems directly. Together, we're making a brighter, more sustainable tomorrow.

Funding energy upgrades to social housing to cut bills and tackle climate change

The Albanese and Minns Labor Governments are partnering with 22 Community Housing providers to upgrade thousands of social housing homes to make them cheaper to run, more comfortable to live in, and better for the environment.

These upgrades will deliver lasting cost of living relief, while making renewable and smart energy features more accessible.

More than 2,300 homes will be upgraded with nearly \$18 million in joint funding from the Australian and NSW Governments, as well as Community Housing Providers.

The upgrades will include a range of potential measures:

- rooftop solar panels and shared solar systems
- reverse cycle air conditioning
- energy-efficient hot water systems

- ceiling insulation, window shading and draught proofing
- LED lighting and ceiling fans.

These upgrades will help keep homes warmer in winter, cooler in summer and make them cheaper to run. It will help vulnerable households save on energy bills while cutting emissions across the state.

For more information scan the QRCode.

SAGE MORUYA SPRING SOLSTICE DINNER

Sunday 21 September

Gates open 3.30pm for 4pm dinner

SAGE Garden 110 Queen Street, Moruya

Step into the promise of warmer days and brighter evenings at the SAGE Spring Solstice! We invite you to gather with friends, family, and fellow food lovers for a heartwarming celebration that marks the joyful end of winter and the vibrant arrival of spring.

Our menu showcases the freshest local spring produce through a mouth-watering selection of homemade soups to chase away the last chills of winter crafted from the season's best ingredients plus freshly baked breads from the pizza oven, and a selection of cakes and live music.

BYO picnic rug, drinks, chair, soup bowl or mug, plates, cutlery, and drinking vessels.

Dirty car sales are down

According To Our World In Data, global sales of internal combustion engine cars – which run solely on petrol or diesel – peaked in 2016 at 80.47m. Electric and plug-in hybrid car sales in that year were just 780,000.

Last year, sales of dirty cars were 62.05m, a 23% fall. Electric and plug-in hybrid car sales had increased to 17.5m.

Put another way, nearly a decade ago only one in every 100 cars sold across the globe was electric. Now it is more than one in five.

Australian secondhand Battery Electric Car sales surge in first half of 2025

BEVs took a record share of the secondhand market in the first half of 2025, with sales up 92.2% on the same period in 2024.



Despite a drop in demand for passenger cars in the wider used market, used BEVs have seen 16,398 units sold this year to date, up 92.2% on the same period in 2024.

The number of secondhand BEVs available on the second-hand market rose 88.9%, from 9,848 on the market in the first half of 2024, to 17,914 this year.

New EV sales hit a record high in 2024 and, according to a report by JOLT, [Australia is on track to surpass 300,000 EVs on the road](#) by the end of this year.

Owning an EV is increasingly affordable, through secondhand sales and state-specific incentives and financial incentives for EV buyers, including the [Electric Car Discount legislation](#), as well as green loans from the Australian government's green bank, Clean Energy Finance Corporation (CEFC).

To support EV uptake across the country, the Australian government recently launched a new [dedicated website to provide information to Australians about buying, owning, and maintaining an EV](#). This includes EV basics, such as types of vehicles, as well as the necessary knowledge about EV charging infrastructure, whether that be at home, kerbside, private or public.

EUROBEV HERE

Have Your Say – Help Us Improve SHASA’s Website

When was the last time you visited SHASA’s website?

We’re currently reviewing our digital strategy and would love your input to help shape a refreshed and more effective online presence.

We’d like to know:

- How you use the current technology website
- What you think it should be used for
- Who it should be targeted to — prospective, new, or existing members
- Whether it reflects and promotes SHASA’s work effectively

With over six years of content on the site, we also want your thoughts on what should stay — and what can go.

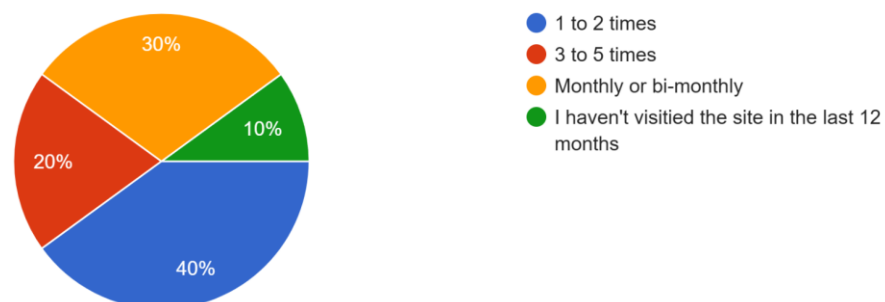
Please take a few minutes to complete our short survey.

Your feedback will help us make SHASA’s website more useful, engaging and aligned with our mission.

What have (10) people said so far?

In the last 12 months, how often have you visited the SHASA website?

10 responses



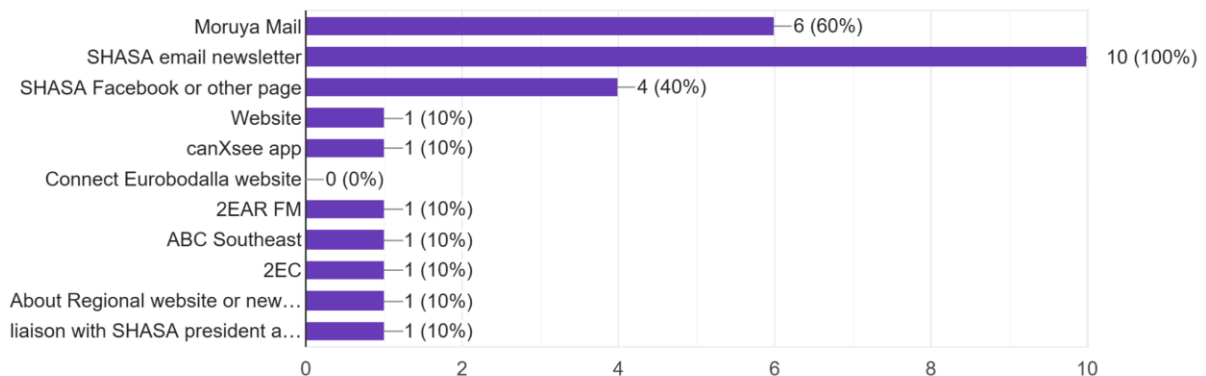
50% have visited the website once or twice in past year, or not at all!
The remaining 50% visit the website monthly, bi-monthly or quarterly.

The majority use the website for SHASA events information, while one third of respondents said they go there to find information about renewable energy.

SHASA's newsletter, The Spark, is an important source of news and information, as is Moruya Mail, and SHASA's Facebook page, for keeping up to date on SHASA's activities.

How do you keep up to date with what SHASA is up to? (tick all that apply)

10 responses



There is interest in being able to sign up to curated newsfeeds from the SHASA website, and having a signup page for people to get involved, as well as having more video content.

Features and functionality that I would interested in (tick all that apply):

10 responses

